

Laptops

Workhorse

MSI MegaBook M510C

Specs: Pentium M 1.5 GHz, 256 MB, 15" screen, 40 GB hard drive, combo drive

Our Verdict: Blazing performance saw the M510C take the crown in the workhorse category. The Megabook M510C also offers a good configuration for the price.

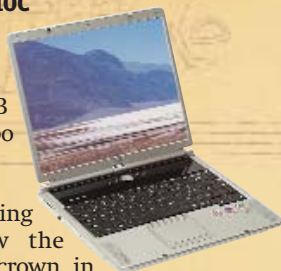
Runner-up: Wipro CP

Lifestyle LG LM-50

Specs: Pentium-M 1.5 GHz, 256 MB, 15" screen, 60 GB hard drive, combo drive

Our Verdict: The LM-50 will appeal with its good looks. An excellent performer in its category, it posted good scores in our tests. Features are limited, but one won't find any essential features missing.

Runner-up: Compaq X1237AP and Toshiba Satellite M30



Ultra-portable Dell Latitude X300

Specs: Pentium M 1.2 GHz, 384 MB, 12" screen, 30 GB hard disk, external USB combo drive, docking station and an extra battery

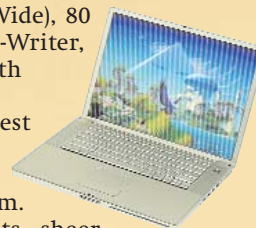
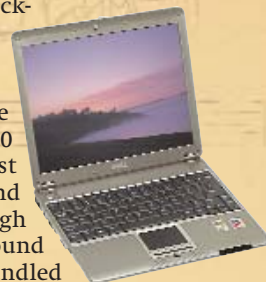
Our Verdict: The Dell Latitude X300 has the slimmest profile of all, and is compact enough to be carried around easily. It comes bundled with all the necessary bells and whistles and has an assortment of accessories to choose from.

Runner-up: Fujitsu Lifebook S2020

Apple G4 PowerBook 17 inch

Specs: Power PC G4 1.5 GHz, 512 MB, 17" screen (Wide), 80 GB hard disk, DVD-Writer, FireWire 800, Bluetooth

Our Verdict: The best designed notebooks in the business, they have their own charm. We praise it for its sheer beauty, not to forget the performance.



Memory Modules

Corsair CMX 3200 LLPT DDR 400 MHz

Specs: 32M x 8 DDR SDRAMs, single bank, Ultra-low latency (2-3-2-6) and SPD programmed for low latency operation.

Our Verdict: When it comes to the best memory modules, enthusiasts and gamers swear by Corsair for the performance and overclocking capabilities on offer. While Corsair has a series of products, their CMX 3200 LLPT modules offer the ultimate in performance. These modules are, by default,



rated for ultra-low (2-3-2-6) latency operation work. They have no compatibility issues with most chipsets such as Intel, VIA, SiS, nVidia and ATi, and thus, they work seamlessly with most motherboards. We recommend these memory modules to geeks who like to overclock, and for gamers who want the best.

Runner-up: NA

Flashback To December 2000

Zenith 21A

Specs: 1 GHz Pentium 3 processor, 128 MB RAM, 10 GB hard disk, S3-based graphics and CD-ROM

Evolution: Laptops have metamorphosed from the old Pentium III chips to optimised fast Pentium M processors, extremely good graphics and four hours of juice. The Zenith 21A then was priced Rs 1 lakh; today you can buy a powerhouse laptop for that price.

RAM

Evolution: In year 2000, it started with the EDO-RAM modules that were a part of the early Pentium and

Pentium Pro series. EDO-RAM was gradually displaced by a better performing SD-RAM with the introduction of Pentium II and Celeron processors. The working frequency of SD-RAM varied from PC66 to PC133. AMD introduced the DDR feature to SD-RAM modules, these new memories were capable of transferring data at twice the rate of normal SD-RAM. DDR SD-RAM frequency varies from PC266 to PC3200. Though higher frequency modules are available, they are not certified by the governing authority. In year 2004, DDR II standard was introduced, which clocked to run at 533 MHz and above.

